IRONHACK IDOL

Which factors drive sustained global success and which qualities define your next big artist?

Presented by: Gebra, Jacob, and Charles

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01 – STRATEGIC THESIS

OUR PROPOSAL: INVEST IN ARTIST ARCHETYPES

EVALUATION METRICS

Drivers of Success

Follower counts, song popularity, genre: which factors drive sustained global success?

ARCHETYPE DEFINITION

Three Archetypes

Styles from artists with multiple hits in the past 10 years in genres, album types, and track lengths supported by data.

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02 – RESEARCH AGENDA

FOUR QUESTIONS GUIDED INITIAL ANALYSIS

QUESTION 01

Consistent Genres

Which genres are consistently popular the past 10 years?

QUESTION 02

Singles vs. Albums

Do singles or albums perform better?

QUESTION 03

Followers vs Popularity

How do followers and artist popularity relate to track popularity?

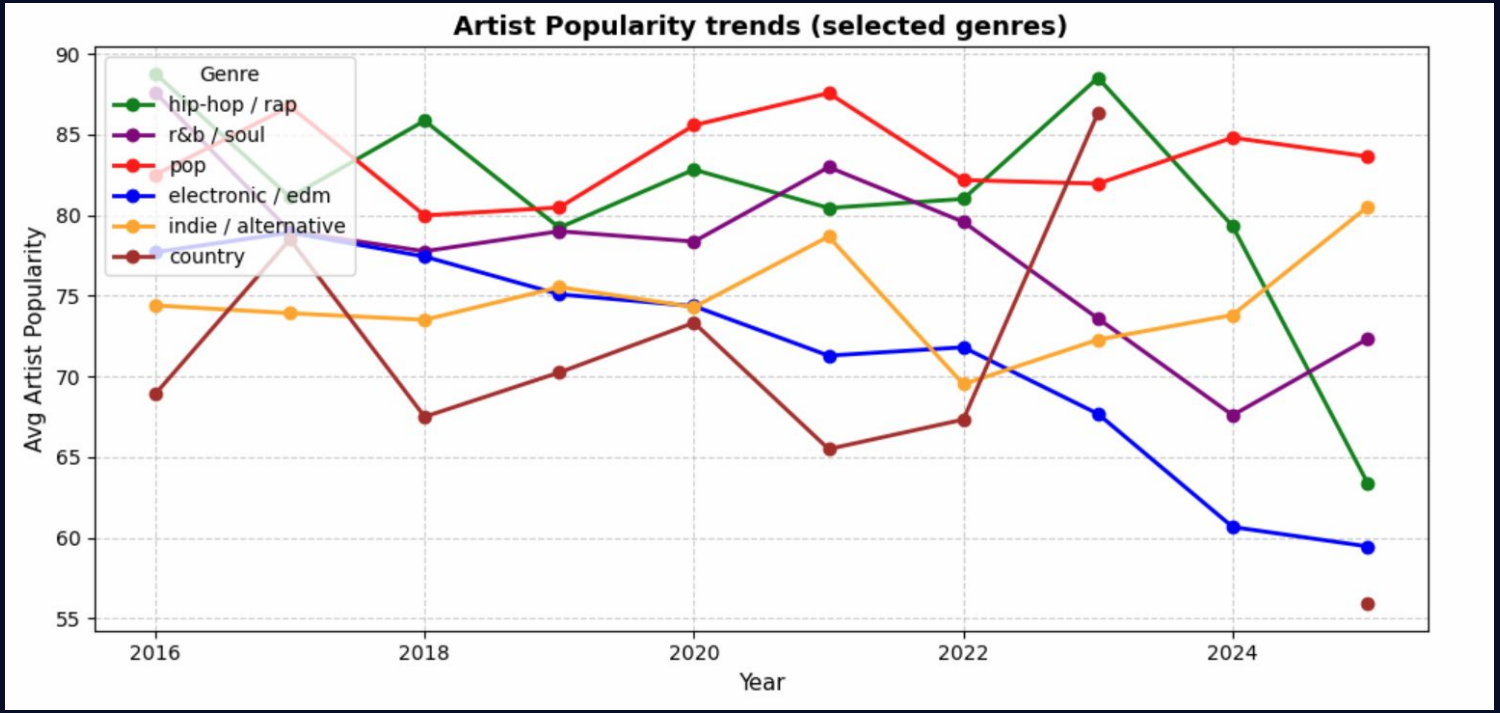
QUESTION 04

Acquire vs. Build

Should the label focus on up-and-coming artists or 'build' artist?

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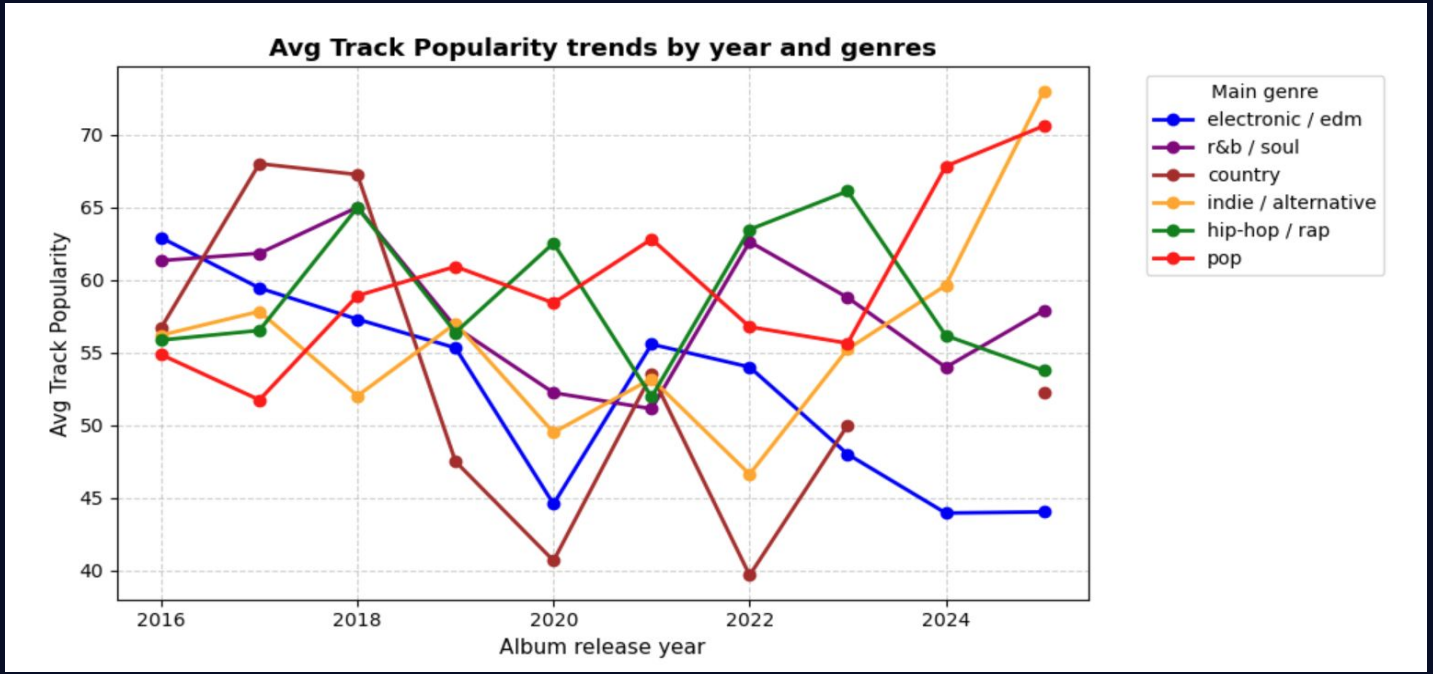
Artist Popularity by Genre



- **Pop and indie have been most stable genres** for artists, which could mean stronger follower loyalty
- **Electronic dance music** has the **strongest decline in multi-hit artists** the past decade

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Track Popularity by Genre



- **Pop and indie** have the emerged as the **popular track leaders the past 2 years**
- **EDM, a genre know for singles**, has more inconsistency around artists durability
- **Country overall trend line is declining**

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Singles vs Albums

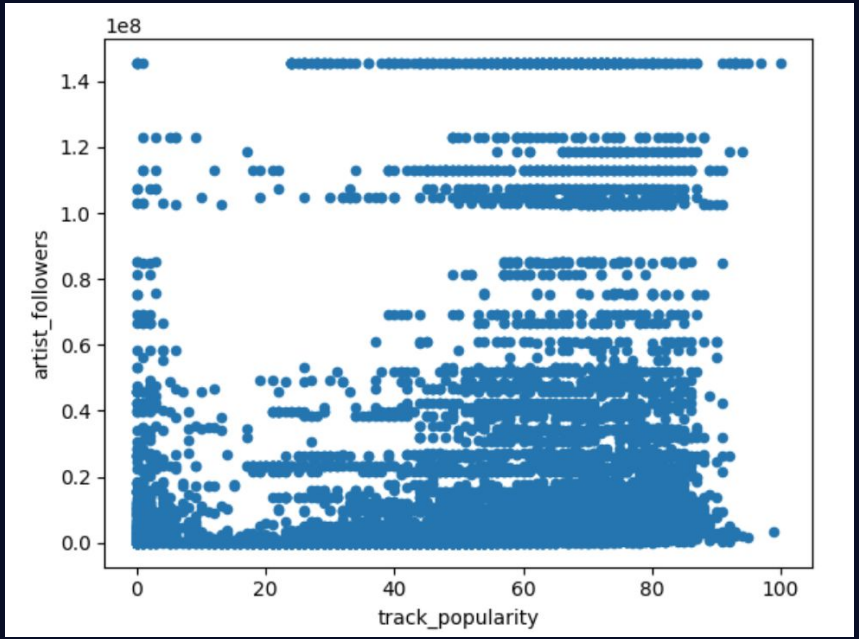
- Albums are generally the most popular form of song consumption
- Pop has similar median popularity but popular songs are extremely popular
- EDM and country both lean towards singles

Possible conclusion:
Singles require less investment and still be successful but may lead to less content for building followers

main_genre	album_type	track_count	mean_popularity	median_popularity
r&b / soul	single	170	50.505882	54.0
	compilation	24	50.458333	48.0
	album	157	65.477707	67.0
pop	single	436	55.027523	65.0
	compilation	46	44.717391	45.0
	album	1315	62.165019	65.0
indie / alternative	compilation	8	35.750000	42.5
	single	81	51.000000	58.0
	album	160	58.968750	62.0
hip-hop / rap	single	181	48.845304	56.0
	compilation	6	54.833333	52.0
	album	581	61.435456	66.0
electronic / edm	single	264	47.734848	51.0
	compilation	2	38.500000	38.5
	album	85	48.941176	48.0
country	compilation	28	38.857143	39.5
	single	21	61.666667	62.0
	album	54	53.833333	51.0

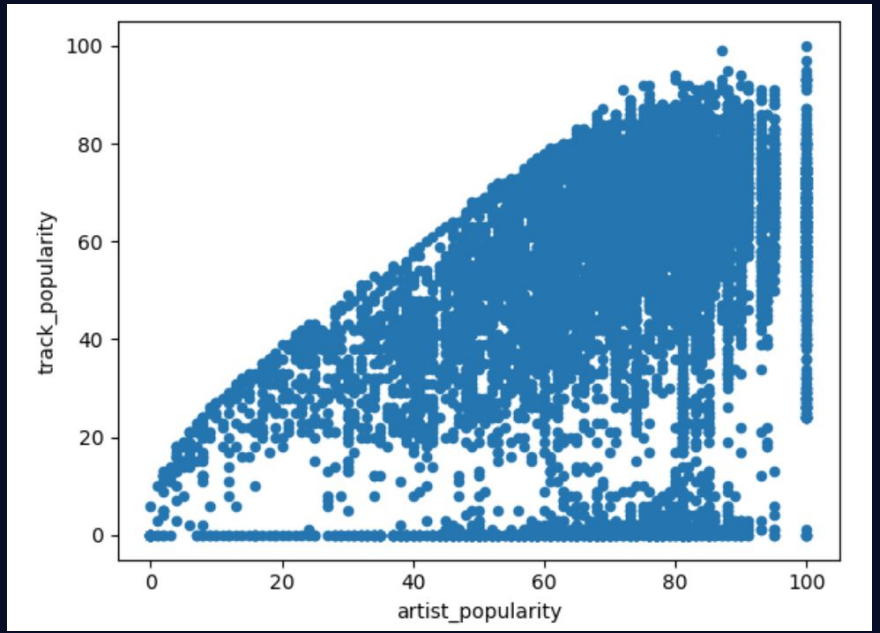
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Artist Followers vs Artist Popularity



Regardless of the quantity of artist followers, tracks can become popular (i.e. all artist with popular tracks have unpopular tracks)

Artist Popularity vs Track Popularity



Track popularity has a clear algorithmic ceiling from artist popularity on Spotify

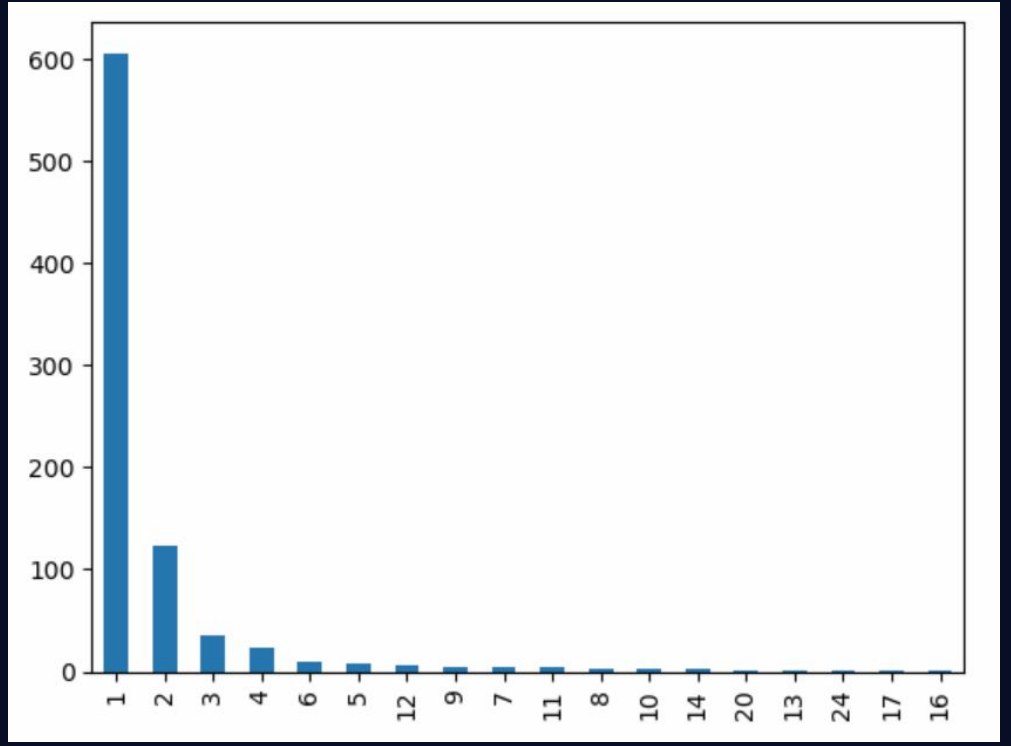
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Up-and-coming artists... are they worth it?

1. We labeled artists with popularity between 35 and 65 as “up-and-coming”.

2. Conclusions around sustained success are difficult because many lack multiple hits.

3. Artists with many hits in this range likely have a “core fan base” that sustains success but lacks commercial appeal to be global.

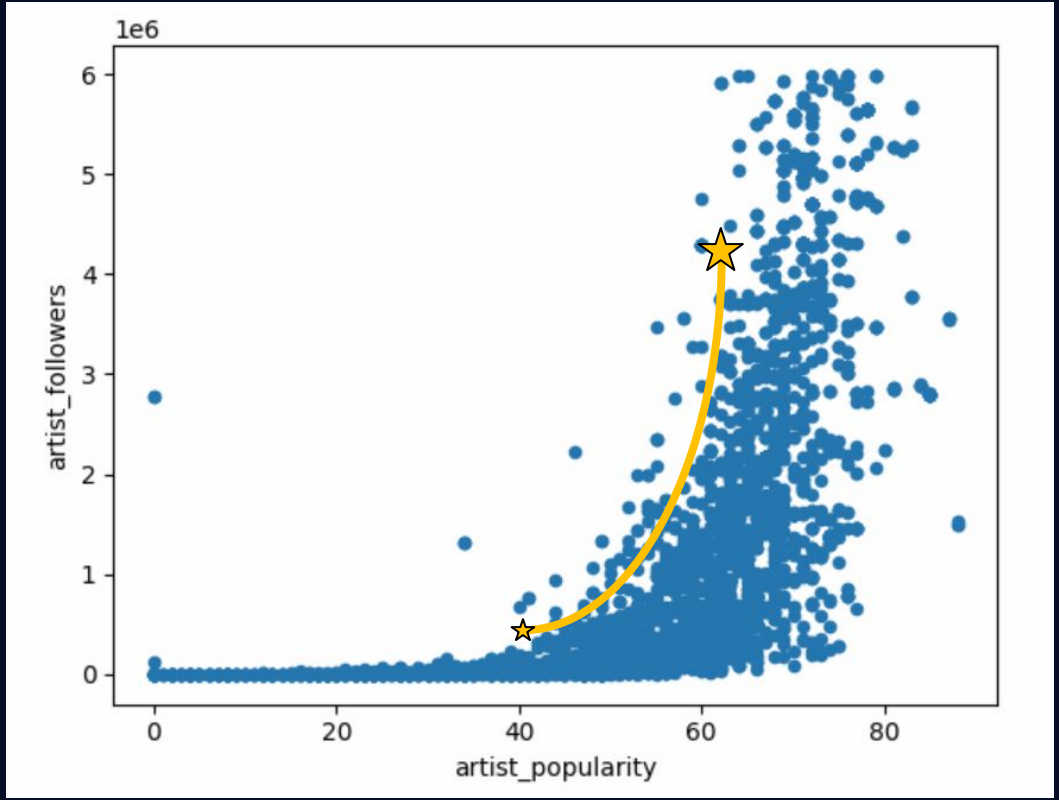


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CORE INSIGHT #1

The Artist Breakout Point

Roughly between 300k and 500k followers and a **artist popularity of 40** seems to be the "tipping point" for a superstar trajectory.



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CORE INSIGHT #2

"You're not just building popular songs, your building an artist people want to follow."

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METHODOLOGY

BUILD THE ARCHETYPES

Repeat demand

Replicate the appeal of artists with repeat hits in the past 10 years.

Format & longevity

Use genres that perform consistently over time.

Song-length window

Build hit songs between 3 and 4 minutes in length.

Style synthesis

Use modern technology to build ideal artist profiles from 5 artists in each genre.

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Track Sample: *Almost Love Me by NOVA (link1)*
Track Sample: *Almost Love Me by NOVA (link2)*

ARCHETYPE 01 · POP

NOVA

Pop Powerhouse

THE PITCH

"An arena-sized voice but every song feels like it's for you."

IDEAL FORMAT & SONG LEGNTH FOR HITS

Type: Album

3 minutes 23 seconds

SONIC SIGNATURE

Soulful verses with explosive, danceable choruses.
Love, belonging, and courage.
Exceptional voice with a full band or alone on piano.

VISUAL IDENTITY

Shimmering tailored outfits, curly hair, and electric blue and pink lighting. Glamorous, confident, and approachable.



ARCHETYPE 02 · INDIE / ALTERNATIVE

ELLIS VANCE

Dreamy Indie Songwriter

THE PITCH

"Songs that sound like a favorite memory or tell your secret feelings."

IDEAL FORMAT & SONG LGENTH FOR HITS

Type: Album

3 minutes 36 seconds

SONIC SIGNATURE

Conversational vocals, gentle wavy guitars, warm bass, synths.
Written like a diary with a catchy chorus.
If it's not stuck in your head, it's not his song.

VISUAL IDENTITY

Worn knitwear, vintage instruments, earthy colours, and grainy photography. Quiet charisma with a playful streak.

Track Sample: *Is it just the night? by Ellis Vance (link)*



ARCHETYPE 03 · R&B / SOUL

SABLE BANKS

R&B Edgy Storyteller

THE PITCH

"Private thoughts. Velvet vocals. Grooves that stays with you."

IDEAL FORMAT & SONG LENGTH FOR HITS

Type: Album

3 minutes 25 seconds

SONIC SIGNATURE

Soft vocals over deep bass and hazy synths.
Intimate verses open into lush harmonies.
Edgy and mildly misbehaved.

VISUAL IDENTITY

Soft luxury, minimalist jewellery, dark clothing, and cinematic portraits.
Confident, sensual, and approachable.

Track Sample: *don't be so polite by sable (link)*

NEXT: STRENGTHEN THE DATA FOUNDATION

PHASE 1 · SCHEMA ENHANCEMENT

Structural Data Enrichment

- Build a more sophisticated data structure to track artists with unique IDs and subgenres + MORE DATA.

PHASE 2 · GROUP INTERVIEWS & TESTING

Artist Profile Testing

- Begin sampling AI created songs with groups to build “sonic profiles” and “build the next new artist”.

PHASE 3 · PREDICITIVE MODELING

ML Track Popularity Forecasting

- Develop ML models to forecast the potential popularity score of unreleased songs.

PHASE 4 · EXTERNAL DATA INTEGRATION

Social Media Early Detection

- Integrate social media metrics and external streaming signals to identify fast-growing artists who fit refine archetype criteria.

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